JLA RECOVERY SOLUTIONS, LLC

CAPABILITY STATEMENT

COMPANY OVERVIEW

JLA Recovery Solutions, LLC is a disaster recovery consultancy led by James Ariail, a disaster recovery executive with two decades of leadership across Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) Headquarters, national consulting firms, and state and local recovery programs. We help state and local governments, and the national firms that support them, plan, stand up, and deliver recovery programs funded by the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) Community Development Block Grant Disaster Recovery (CDBG-DR) program and FEMA Public Assistance (PA), Individual Assistance (IA), and Hazard Mitigation Assistance (HMA).

Our principal brings a combination that is uncommon in this field: deep expertise in both FEMA programs and CDBG-DR, and in how they fit together. That helps clients layer funding sources, manage duplication of benefits, and design programs that move recovery dollars quickly and compliantly.

CORE COMPETENCIES

CDBG-DR Program Design and Implementation

- Action Plans built for rapid HUD approval, with financial and grants management certifications
- Program design that moves funding out the door while controlling administrative and activity delivery costs
- Compliance with Federal Register requirements, 2 CFR 200, duplication of benefits, and environmental review

FEMA Programs (PA, IA, HMA)

- Insider's view of IA policy and operations from FEMA Headquarters, including Direct Housing and Mass Care
- Match strategies pairing CDBG-DR with PA and Hazard Mitigation Grant Program (HMGP) projects
- HMA grant policy and implementation support, from Unified Guidance to portfolio management

Disaster Housing Recovery

- Housing strategy across the continuum, from sheltering to permanent housing
- Creative use of existing ("blue sky") HUD funding and waivers before CDBG-DR arrives
- Multifamily housing pairing CDBG-DR with Low-Income Housing Tax Credits (LIHTC)
- Alternative housing technology evaluation

Program Stand-Up and Operations

- Rapid stand-up of applicant intake, case management, eligibility, and award operations
- Recruiting, training, and quality control for large surge teams
- Policies, procedures, and manuals for CDBG-DR, Emergency Rental Assistance (ERAP), and CARES Act programs

Recovery Planning and Facilitation

- Pre-disaster recovery planning, including Housing Recovery Support Function (RSF) annexes
- Executive facilitation that drives state and federal decisions on recovery operations
- Policy and guidance development, including the National Disaster Recovery Framework (NDRF) update

Capture and Proposal Support

- Capture strategy, client pre-positioning, and teaming for FEMA and CDBG-DR pursuits
- Technical approach, staffing plan, and pricing strategy review
- Key personnel and oral presentation support

WHY JLA RECOVERY SOLUTIONS

- **FEMA and HUD depth in one advisor:** IA leadership experience at FEMA Headquarters and CDBG-DR program leadership since the Hurricane Ike recovery
- **Proven HUD results:** Asheville's first CDBG-DR Action Plan, developed in under 90 days and approved by HUD with no required changes
- **Rapid mobilization:** 100+ shelter staff deployed in 72 to 96 hours (Harvey); 200+ staff at peak production in three weeks (Build It Back)
- **Multi-disaster depth:** Katrina, Ike, Sandy, Matthew, Harvey, the Camp Fire, COVID-19, Helene, and Milton
- **Small business teaming partner:** SAM.gov-registered small business with teaming and on-call agreements with national firms
- **Technology-enabled delivery:** developer of the DisasterData iOS app; uses data and AI tools to speed routine work, with senior expert review of every work product

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SELECTED EXPERIENCE OF OUR PRINCIPAL

Led by James Ariail in senior roles with prior firms.

ENGAGEMENT AND CLIENT	ROLE AND RESULTS
Helene CDBG-DR Action Plan ($225M) City of Asheville, NC	**Program Manager.** Advised City leadership after Helene; developed the City's first Action Plan in under 90 days, approved by HUD with no required changes.
CDBG-DR Program ($108M) Nebraska Dept. of Economic Development	**Program Manager.** Led the State's first Action Plan through implementation, including affordable multifamily housing paired with LIHTC and an Infrastructure Match Program for PA and HMGP.
ERAP and CARES Act Housing Programs Louisiana; California; Miami-Dade County	**Grants Administration Director; Project Executive.** Stood up ERAP eligibility operations in Louisiana; oversaw ~80 staff in California; launched three Miami-Dade programs ($30.1M) in two weeks.
Alternative Housing Studies Texas General Land Office	**Project Executive; Principal Investigator.** Five years of repeat task orders evaluating 3D printed, modular, and foldable housing (lab tested with Texas A&M) and post-Ike home resiliency.
FEMA Pre-Disaster Recovery Pilots Pre-Disaster Housing Initiative and STARS	**SME and Senior Facilitator.** Facilitated FEMA and state executive sessions; led New Jersey's Housing RSF Annex and New Hampshire's State Recovery Plan update.
Camp Fire Housing Recovery State of California (Cal OES)	**Housing Task Force Leader; Housing RSF Lead.** Represented the State with FEMA on the interim housing mission and led long-term housing recovery coordination for Paradise.
Hurricane Harvey Shelter Staffing FEMA (Texas)	**Senior Program Manager.** First major FEMA deployment of contractor staff to shelters: 100+ staff hired, trained, badged, and deployed in 72 to 96 hours; FEMA letter of commendation.
Build It Back and NY Rising (Sandy) New York City and New York State	**Program Manager.** Six intake centers and a call center; 200+ staff serving 10,000+ applicants at peak production within three weeks; 3,000+ NY Rising damage assessments.

PRINCIPAL

James L. Ariail III | Principal

James Ariail founded JLA Recovery Solutions in 2025 after seven years as Hagerty Consulting's Director of Disaster Housing, where he led the firm's disaster housing portfolio. He previously held senior roles at APTIM, Tetra Tech (Vice President), and URS, and earlier in his career led planning, policy, and analysis for Direct Housing and Mass Care in FEMA Headquarters' Individual Assistance Division, including more than $1 billion in federal procurements. He has supported CDBG-DR programs in leadership roles since the Hurricane Ike recovery and is a recognized subject matter expert in CDBG-DR, disaster housing, FEMA IA, and HMA.

Education: Master of Urban and Regional Planning, University of Pittsburgh | BA, Economics and Political Science, Virginia Tech

Continuing Education: MIT Sloan Executive Education, Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy

Publications: Articles on locally led post-disaster housing and FEMA housing assistance policy, Disaster Discourse (2019)

COMPANY DATA

UEI: GXE7EZD2JLA5
CAGE: 197N6
NAICS: 541611, 541618, 541620
Size: Small Business (SAM.gov)
Structure: Single-Member LLC (Virginia)
Location: Vienna, Virginia

Teaming and advisory inquiries welcome

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